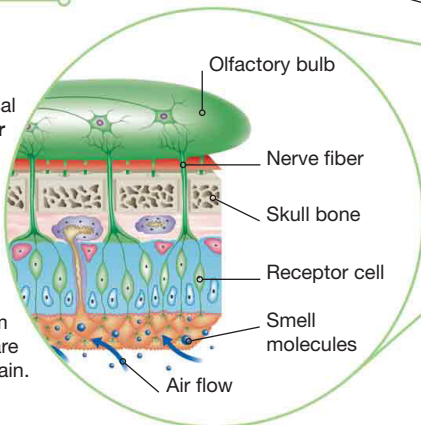


Smelling

The nose has tiny detectors that pick up a vast range of smells, from freshly baked bread to the stink of rotten eggs. The smell detectors in the nose work closely with the tongue's taste sensors to allow us to appreciate flavors, too.

In the roof of the nasal cavity, **odor receptor cells** detect smell molecules dissolved in watery mucus. Nerve fibers carry signals from the receptors to the olfactory bulb at the front of the brain. From there, the signals are sent to the brain.



The **olfactory bulb** carries signals to the brain

Detecting smells

Air breathed in through the nose carries smell molecules. These are detected by odor receptors located at the top of the nasal cavity—the space that links the nostrils to the throat. The receptors send signals to the brain, which identifies each smell.

The **nasal cavity** channels inhaled air

The **tongue** houses taste receptors

Nerves carry signals from taste receptors to the brain

